



the Taj group has set a number of sustainability goals with the target of making the procuring commercial cleaning supplies and they make in-house bio enzymes for

able by 2030. In addition to going single-use-plastic free, adopting sustainable water management practices and renewable energy sources, IHCL's sustainability journey will also involve a 100 per cent adoption of UNESCO's cultural heritage projects in the geographies it is present in, according to Pokhariyal. It has also weaved into its operations sustainable practices—through new offerings and changes in existing processes.

IHCL has entered into agreements with various players for sourcing green energy. "This source of energy is not just green but also costs lesser [than conventional energy], making it an additional incentive for our properties. For example, we have joined hands



"As guests seek fulfilling experiences in harmony with nature and socio-cultural surroundings... they are choosing brands based on their sustainability initiatives and are willing to pay a premium"

Anuraag Bhatnagar
COO, THE LEELA PALACE
HOTELS AND RESORTS

with Tata Power to provide solar energy for our Mumbai hotels for a period of 25 years, which will get approximately 60 per cent energy from green sources, reducing nearly 23 million kg of CO₂ emissions on an annual basis," explains Pokhariyal.

Of course, sustainability comes at a cost. "Up to 2030, there will be an annual investment in green initiatives, which is a major part of our capital expenses going forward," he says.

Puri of the Indian School of Hospitality believes that guests are willing to pay extra for sustainable measures. "There is a cost attached to sustainability but then you charge the customer more. While there is more of an investment in the initial stages, hotels will benefit more from it. They can charge a premium for their sustainable initiatives. Consumers are demanding it, consumers will pay for it."

Sustainability is big globally. IHG Hotels & Resorts—which owns brands such as InterContinental, Crowne Plaza, Holiday Inn, etc.—launched its 'Journey to Tomorrow' programme last year. "We call it a journey as we haven't got all the answers yet, but we see this as an important framework to bring together all who stay, work and partner with us to shape the future of responsible travel," says Sudeep Jain, MD (South West Asia), IHG Hotels & Resorts. The plan includes a target of 100 per cent of all newly-built hotels to operate at very low- or zero-carbon emissions by 2030. "To address this challenge, we are adding key efficiency measures into our newly-built brand standards, and